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United States v. John Doe a/k/a 'HYDRA9' — Indictment (SDNY 1:26-cr-00244)

Document kind: indictment
Entity: Obsidian Ventures — Netherlands
Registration: NL-KVK-74559032
Domain: obsidian-ventures.eu
Address: Herengracht 420, 1017 BZ Amsterdam
Directors: Maarten V. de Groot
Owner reference: Hydra9 (user id 8)
Contact email: hydra9@onionvault.io
Payment wallet BTC: bc1qhydra9m1xerfake1a2b3c4d5e6f7g8h9i0j1k

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT — SOUTHERN DISTRICT OF NEW YORK

UNITED STATES OF AMERICA,)
) INDICTMENT
— against —) Cr. No. 1:26-cr-00244 (SDNY)
)
JOHN DOE, a/k/a "HYDRA9",) (Sealed; to be unsealed
a/k/a "H9", a/k/a "Hydra_EU",) concurrently with the
a/k/a "H9_mix",) OFAC designation
Defendant.) 2026-03-09)

THE GRAND JURY CHARGES:

Count One — Operation of an Unlicensed Money Transmitting Business
(18 U.S.C. §1960)

1. From on or about June 2021 through the date of this Indictment, the defendant designed, deployed and operated the HYDRA9 cryptocurrency mixing service, a virtual-asset mixing service accessible via clearnet redirects and via Tor at hydra9pool7ybufake3x8fhp2k9j4u1abcdef23.onion.
2. HYDRA9 functioned as a money-transmitting business within the meaning of 31 U.S.C. §5330 and 31 C.F.R. §1010.100(ff)(5)(i)(B). It was not registered with the Financial Crimes Enforcement Network (FinCEN) as required by 31 U.S.C. §5330. The defendant knew the service was so required and willfully failed to register.
3. The service processed in excess of USD 380,000,000 of virtual-currency value during the indictment period, of which the defendant knew substantial portions were derived from unlawful activity — including ransomware proceeds (notably from the BlackVortex Locker affiliate program), business e-mail compromise proceeds, and proceeds from the sale of fentanyl precursors.

Count Two — Conspiracy to Commit Money Laundering (18 U.S.C. §1956(h))

Count Three — Money Laundering — Promotion (18 U.S.C. §1956(a)(1)(A)(i))
Count Four — Money Laundering — Concealment (18 U.S.C. §1956(a)(1)(B)(i))
Count Five — International Money Laundering (18 U.S.C. §1956(a)(2)(B)(i))
Counts Six through Twelve — Substantive money laundering counts as set forth in the Schedule attached.

FORFEITURE ALLEGATIONS:

Upon conviction, the defendant shall forfeit to the United States all property, real or personal, involved in such offenses, including:

- (a) the contents of bc1qhydra9m1xerfake1a2b3c4d5e6f7g8h9i0j1k
- (b) the contents of 0xHyDra9Mix0000000000000000000000dEAdC0De
- (c) the rotation address tree identified as 'pool-2025-rotation' in the seizure warrant of even date herewith.

A TRUE BILL.

Foreperson	DAMIAN WILLIAMS
	United States Attorney
	Southern District of New York

Note: parallel civil action — OFAC SDN designation OFAC-2026-0309-HYDRA9MIX, issued same day by the U.S. Department of the Treasury under E.O. 13694, as amended.

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